IRB Feeback/Action Items

The survey will be administered online using Qualtrics. Prior to beginning the survey, participants will be presented with an informed consent form outlining the purpose of the study, procedures, potential risks and benefits, confidentiality measures, and contact information for the research team and Institutional Review Board. Participants must indicate their consent before proceeding to the survey.
The survey will include a combination of closed-ended (e.g., Likert-scale) and open-ended questions. Survey items will assess participants' perceptions of their experiences as PALs, including academic development, sense of belonging, leadership and communication skills, career readiness, and transferable skills.
Participation will be confidential, but not anonymous. Identifying information will be collected only for the purpose of follow-up interviews and will be stored separately from survey responses. Data will be stored securely and accessible only to the research team.
Participants may skip any question they do not wish to answer and may exit the survey at any time without penalty. Submission of the survey will indicate completion of participation in this portion of the study.
The supervisor will not have access to individual survey responses and identifiable data will not be shared with supervisors or used for employment-related decisions. The supervisor will not know who participated unless a participant chooses to disclose that information. Data will be analyzed and reported only in aggregate or with de-identified quotations.

IRB Reviewer 07-02-2026 9:53 AM
Is the survey anonymous? Or will you collect names to link to other data?

If you add a link, how will you protect employee responses from potential retribution, etc. from supervisors?

Participants will be recruited from current and former Peer Academic Leaders (PALs) in the First-Year Experience (FYE) program at California State University, Chico. Recruitment will occur via email invitation sent to eligible individuals using program records. The recruitment message will include a description of the study, eligibility criteria, and a link to the online survey.
Participation in the study will be entirely voluntary. The recruitment communication and survey introduction will clearly state that participation or non-participation will have no impact on students' employment, academic standing, or relationship with the university or FYE program. To minimize potential coercion, individuals in direct supervisory roles will not track or monitor who chooses to participate.

ATTACHED:
Title: Outcomes in Learner Support Personnel in FYE, IRB #2022-89

PI Contact Information: Sue Peterson, sepeterson@csuchico.edu, 530-898-6495

Risk Level: This study involves **minimal risk**, as the potential harms are limited to minor psychological discomfort and the unlikely risk of loss of confidentiality associated with participation in surveys and interviews about participants' experiences as Peer Academic Leaders.

Eligibility Criteria: Participants should be currently employed by First-Year Experience at Chico State in the role of Peer Academic Leader.

Voluntary Nature of Study: To further reduce the potential for undue influence, recruitment will occur through a standardized email invitation, and participants will communicate directly with the research team rather than through their supervisors. Individual participation and survey responses will not be disclosed to supervisors or considered in employment-related decisions.

Tasks involved: Participants will complete an online survey regarding their experiences serving as Peer Academic Leaders (PALs) in the First-Year Experience (FYE) program. Participants who consent to future

contact may be invited to complete follow-up surveys at designated intervals to assess changes over time. Each survey is expected to take approximately 15–20 minutes. Participants will also be asked to provide identifying information to permit longitudinal follow-up and linkage with institutional academic records. This information will be kept confidential and stored separately from survey responses whenever feasible.

IRB Reviewer 07-02-2026 9:55 AM

Please upload/attach the draft text for your recruitment email.
Make sure the text includes all of the following elements:

- Title of study
- PI contact information.
- State the risk level and risks involved.
- Eligibility criteria.
- The voluntary nature of the study **given you are working with your own students/employees.**
- A brief description of the tasks involved.
- Include the institution name in some way: "Chico State" or "CSU, Chico"
- Include the IRB protocol for reference: IRB #2022-89

This study will collect both quantitative and qualitative data to examine the outcomes associated with serving as a Peer Academic Leader (PAL) in the First-Year Experience (FYE) program at California State University, Chico. Quantitative data will be collected through an online survey administered via Qualtrics. The survey will gather self-reported information related to participants' experiences and perceived development in the following areas: academic success (e.g., academic confidence, engagement), sense of belonging, leadership development, communication skills, career readiness, and transferable skills. The survey will also collect limited demographic and background information, such as length of time in the PAL role and current or former PAL status. All survey responses will be recorded electronically within the survey platform and stored on secure, password-protected systems accessible only to the research team. Interview data will be collected via audio recording (with participant consent) and transcribed for analysis. Transcripts will be de-identified to remove any personally identifying information.
If participants provide consent, institutional data may be accessed to supplement self-reported measures. These data may include academic indicators such as GPA, academic standing, and enrollment status for the purpose of examining academic success and persistence outcomes.
Qualitative data will be collected through semi-structured interviews with a subset of current and former PALs (alumni). These interviews will explore participants' reflections on their experiences in the PAL role and the long-term application of skills developed through the program, particularly in academic, professional, and leadership contexts. Interviews will be conducted in a Chico State Zoom and recorded via Zoom's note-taking system.
If identifying information is collected (e.g., for follow-up interviews or linking survey and institutional data), it will be stored separately from survey responses and replaced with unique participant codes. A master list linking identifiers to participant codes will be stored securely and accessible only to the principal investigator.
All data will be retained and managed in accordance with institutional data security policies and IRB requirements.

IRB Reviewer 07-02-2026 9:59 AM

Please upload/attach a copy of your interview protocol and questions for review.

Hello FYE Student Employees: The following online survey, based on one created by the UVU Mentor Program, is part of an important university study aimed to collect data on what FYE Student Employees learn during a semester working with FYE. It will take approximately 20-30 minutes to complete. Taking part in this research is completely voluntary. If you choose to participate in this research, it is very important that you

answer the questions as thoughtfully and frankly as possible. All your answers will be kept strictly confidential. You can stop participating at any time without penalty. We also emphasize that you will NOT be penalized if you choose to omit answers to some questions on the survey. To record your answers, you must proceed all the way through the end of the survey, even if you choose to omit answers to some questions. In addition, proceeding to the very end of the survey will remove any survey response information from the screen on your computer/device, protecting your privacy. Again, your answers are strictly confidential, and we are bound by the rules of this University to maintain this confidentiality. Your information collected as part of this research will be stored on a password-protected computer in a locked oU'ice within the First-Year Experience Program oU'ice and on a protected server that is located behind a secure firewall at the University OU'ice for Institutional Research. You must be 18 years of age or older to take this survey. At the end, you will be asked if you are interested in participating in a follow-up interview that will provide more qualitative information on your experience in the program. This is totally optional. Thank you for filling out this survey as completely and honestly as you can. We are asking you to do this because we value your experience and ideas about how to improve students' experiences here at Chico State. If you'd like more information about this project, contact the First-Year Experience oU'ice at fye@csuchico.edu or (530) 898-3705.

IRB Reviewer 07-02-2026 10:24 AM

Your consent form requires some revisions:

- Include the title of study.
- Add the IRB proposal reference number: 2022-89.
- Clarify "UVU." Participants may not know.
- Revise this phrase " is part of an important university study" as the University is not sponsoring the study. Also, consider removing "important" as it may cause undue influence to participate.
- Indicate all the eligibility requirements (such as Chico State student, FYE employee).
- Identify the risks and benefits of the study.
- Indicate the risk level: Minimal risk and indicate the minimal risks such as data breach.
- Indicate that people can contact the Institutional Review Board if they have concerns about this study.
- Provide IRB contact information: California State University, Chico irb@csuchico.edu (530) 898-3145.
- Indicate that people can print or save a copy of the consent form for their records.
- Indicate that the survey collects demographic data.
- Provide PI name and contact information.
- Update consent mechanism (e.g., Click "I consent") at the end to indicate that participants acknowledge that they are eligible and consent to participate.
- If you plan to use this consent form for the interview as well as the survey, you need to clarify the procedures for the interview such as audio/video recording.
- If you plan to collect academic data (i.e., FERPA protected data) from participants, you need to indicate that and which data.

IRB Reviewer 07-02-2026 10:27 AM

Your consent form indicates that participants need to reply to all items but can skip them as well. This is confusing. Will all items require a response in Qualtrics? If so, you may want to add "No opinion" type options on your scales.

IRB Reviewer 08-25-2026 1:06 PM

In your survey consent form, you indicated that if people participate in the interview that there will be a separate consent form with information. You need to upload that consent form for review.